



ITCHY FEET IN THE NEW YEAR

Have you finalised your travel plans for 2023? Here are some suggestions

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

TRAVEL RESTRICTIONS HAVE been eased in most parts of the world—but with the re-emergence of the Covid threat, do check the advisories before you venture out. As long as you plan in advance and get your visa, the world is your oyster. Whether you are someone who always has her suitcase half packed, ready-to-go, or someone whose passport hasn't seen the light of day for the past few years, 2023 is your time to explore, indulge and rejuvenate.

A Booking.com survey shows that 69 per cent Indian travellers are looking at investing in a vacation in the New Year as it remains a top priority for them. So, where should you go and what should you do? Here are some suggestions:

TRAIN JOURNEYS

There is something immensely nostalgic and laid-back about train journeys. They bring back memories of summer vacations and simpler times. Indulge in some of the most luxurious train journeys across the globe. Travel through the English countryside and back in time on the restored 1920s carriages of Belmond's British Pullman. Ride like the British royals (some carriages on the train were frequently reserved for their use) and visit Sandringham, as well as other stately homes and ancient castles. Or explore Europe on the Venice Simplon-Orient Express, from London to Venice, Paris to Verona, all the way to Istanbul. An absolute treat for Agatha Christie fans.

Looking at combining adventure with a train journey? Go wild with Rovos Rail and venture into the heart of the South African bush on a two-night safari departing from either Pretoria or Durban. Take